DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 7

Marketing strategist

Profession 7 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A marketing strategist decides where a business should spend effort: the audience, the message, the channels, the budget and the measures of success.

What professionals do every day

Runs market research, sets goals, writes the plan, allocates budget across channels, reviews results and adjusts the plan every quarter.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

A business with limited money needs to choose. A strategist ranks options by expected return and risk, and says what to stop.

- Spending spread across too many channels.
- Goals with no measure.
- Plans nobody follows.

Skills you need

- Market research and competitor review.
- Positioning and messaging.
- Budget allocation and scenarios.
- Quarterly planning and OKRs.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Miro	Strategy workshops and maps	Free tier	Paid plans	miro.com
Google Sheets	Budget and scenario models	Free	Paid plans	sheets.google.com
HubSpot Marketing Hub	Campaign planning (free tiers vary)	Free tier	Paid plans	www.hubspot.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Write a one-page positioning statement.
Intermediate	Build a three-scenario budget model.
Advanced	Set one quarterly goal with three measures.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Plan for a training firm.
- **Intermediate:** Launch plan for a clinic.
- **Advanced:** Growth plan for an online shop.

Client-ready portfolio project

A one-year marketing plan for a fictional firm: positioning, three channels with budgets, three scenarios and a quarterly review schedule.

Worked example

Worked example. A budget of Rs 3 lakh over six months split across search (40%), social (30%), email (10%) and testing (20%), with a rule: move 10% from any channel with a CAC above target.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Budget with scenarios

Business problem: A firm has Rs 3 lakh for six months and needs a plan that adapts.

Steps

1. Split the budget across three channels.
2. Model a best, expected and weak scenario for leads.
3. Write the rule for moving money between channels.
4. Summarise the plan in one page.

Expected output: A budget model with three scenarios and a one-page plan.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Scenarios show the range of outcomes; the rule decides when to move money. The plan states what would make the team change course.

Common mistakes

- A plan without a review date.
- Equal budgets for unequal channels.
- Ignoring the cost of staff time.
- Copying a competitor's plan without knowing its numbers.

Freelancing opportunities

- Strategy sprints for small firms.
- Quarterly planning retainers.
- Briefs for 'marketing strategy', 'go-to-market plan', 'marketing plan'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- HubSpot Academy

Part of **Master Freelancing: Marketing**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full text book. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.